

equities. If you followed his advice, it would have taken you six years *to merely break even*. He even singled out Citigroup as a favorite buy—and the stock subsequently plummeted 97%. If you still own Citi today, you are 87% below when that recommendation was made.

After those two columns set up buyers for getting their portfolios cut in half, he went the other way at the worst possible time: On March 6, 2009, Smart Money published “Even Worse Than the Great Depression,” which claimed we were only halfway through the sell-off.³²⁵ hilariously wrong—the market hit bottom *that very day*, tagging 666, and then launching into a furious 139% rally.

A year later, on May 10, 2010, Luskin wrote “Stocks Slide—It’s About Time.”³²⁶ He advised readers to “become cautious” on equities, telling them, “I have my bets placed on Gold. Buy Gold.” Gold rallied a little, fell back down, and five years later, was off -3%. Meanwhile, the S&P 500—Flash Crash and all—doubled over the same five-year period.

Luskin’s partisanship was not done losing his readers money: On May 4, 2012, he exhorted *Wall Street Journal* readers to dump equities because “The 2013 Fiscal Cliff Could Crush Stocks.”³²⁷ He advised readers to “Do the math on dividend taxes,” warning that dividend yields would be lower, and stock prices would be considerably lower—“maybe by 30%.”

Narrator: Not even close.

Over the ensuing year, there was a torrent of dividend increases. And equities? After that May column, the S&P 500 was up modestly for the rest of 2012 and was 35% higher by the end of 2013.

All of these terrible market calls are a classic cognitive error—allowing politics from either side of the partisan aisle to drive your analysis. Bullish when your favored party holds the White House and bearish when not is a recipe for disaster. These epic fails are really just political screeds in the guise of analysis, all of which turned out to be monumental money losers for anyone foolish enough to listen to them.